GARDEN CITY CHURCH

BOARD MEMBER INSTRUCTION GUIDE

VIII. VISION AND MISSION ALIGNMENT

board members are essential in advancing Garden City Church's mission of "Living the Life" and "Telling the Story."

This involves:

- Living as examples of Christlike discipleship
- Actively sharing and demonstrating the Gospel through service and witness.
- Partnering with the pastor to lead the church in fulfilling its divine calling.

CONCLUSION

Serving on the board of Garden City Church is both a high calling and a profound privilege. It requires dedication, humility, and a heart for ministry. By God's grace, board members can fulfill their responsibilities and make a lasting impact on the church and the broader community.

Remember: The pastor is God's gift to the church, and board members are the church's gift to the pastor.

INTRODUCTION

THE PRIVILEGE OF SERVICE

Serving as a board member at Garden City Church is a profound honor and responsibility. Board members are entrusted with the role of being wise counselors and co-laborers with the senior pastor. This position requires a deep commitment to the mission and vision of Garden City Church and an unwavering dedication to serving the congregation and community.

Board members play a critical role in shaping the spiritual and operational direction of the church. They act as stewards of the church's mission, living out the values of "Living the Life"—the internal work of discipleship—and "Telling the Story"—the external expression of our faith in action. This document provides a comprehensive overview of the roles, responsibilities, and expectations of Garden City Church board members.

I. PURPOSE

The purpose of the board is to serve as wise counselors to the senior pastor, offering spiritual and practical support while ensuring the fulfillment of the church's mission. Under the leadership of the pastor, board members provide comprehensive guidance to ensure the effective operation of the church.

II. RELATIONSHIP

Board members are chosen by the senior pastor, with the consensus of the congregation. Their primary relationship is one of partnership with the senior pastor, supporting him in leading the church. Board members must work collaboratively with the pastor and one another, maintaining a spirit of unity and mutual respect.

III. PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITIES

MAINTAIN SPIRITUAL LIFE

- **Regular Worship:** Attend weekly worship services at Garden City Church consistently.
- **Prayer Participation:** Regularly attend at least one weekly prayer meeting and commit to a personal prayer life.
- **Devotional Life:** Maintain a strong personal devotional life to ensure ministry is done from the “overflow” of the Holy Spirit.

CONTINUED SELF-IMPROVEMENT

- **Training:** Attend at least one leadership training or conference annually.
- **Reading:** Commit to reading at least one book on leadership or ministry annually.
- **Growth:** Pursue ongoing personal spiritual growth and increased ministry effectiveness.

IV. MINISTRY RESPONSIBILITIES

PRAYER TIME

- Join the pastor in prayer before services.
- Be available to minister at the altar during services.
- Regularly attend and participate in weekly prayer meetings.

ATTENDANCE

- Attend weekly services consistently and communicate with the pastor about any absences.
- Actively participate in special meetings such as revivals, conferences, and crusades.
- Attend all regular and specially called business meetings.

RELATIONAL MINISTRY

- Cultivate relationships within the church community to foster a loving, supportive culture.
- Engage in visitation to hospitals, nursing homes, and with shut-ins.
- Show hospitality to new members and ministry groups through fellowship.
- Extend encouragement through phone calls, cards, and emails.
- Utilize provided information sheets to connect with church members and visitors.

V. MINISTRY PORTFOLIOS

- Each board member will develop a ministry portfolio in consultation with the pastor. This portfolio will outline specific ministry assignments and responsibilities.
- Regularly review and adjust the portfolio in alignment with the church's evolving needs.

VI. BOARD MEETINGS

ATTENDANCE AND PARTICIPATION

- Attend all board meetings, ensuring absenteeism does not exceed 25% of meetings.
- Notify the pastor in advance if unable to attend a meeting.

AGENDA AND CONFIDENTIALITY

- Submit agenda items to the pastor at least 48 hours before meetings.
- Maintain strict confidentiality regarding all discussions and decisions made during board meetings. This includes not sharing information with spouses or other individuals.

CONDUCT AND DECISION-MAKING

- Engage in discussions with Christian courtesy and mutual respect.
- Avoid gossip and strive for open, honest communication.
- Aim for consensus in decision-making, prioritizing unity over personal preferences.
- Provide constructive criticism privately, following biblical principles outlined in 1 Timothy 5:1 and 5:17.

VII. AGREEMENT AND COMMITMENT

- Acknowledge the spiritual significance of the board member role.
- Commit to acting with integrity, humility, and wisdom.
- Recognize the dual nature of the role as both a business executive and a servant leader.
- Embrace the responsibility of caring for and discipling the congregation in love and faith.